“Śrī Caitanya-caritāmṛta”

Antya-līlā

Chapter 16

Grace to Kālidāsa, and the Ravings of Madness in Separation

(English translation from the Bengali, following the Gauḍīya Maṭha edition and the «Anubhāṣya», 2026 — draft)

1 I bow down to Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya, who Himself tasted the nectar of feelings for Kṛṣṇa and gave it to His devotees to taste; so He taught them the path of divine love.[1]

2 Glory, glory to Śrī Caitanya! Glory to Nityānanda! Glory to Advaitacandra, and glory to all the devotees of Gaura!

3 In this way Mahāprabhu lived in Nīlācala with His devotees, always overwhelmed by love.

4 The next year all the devotees of Gauḍa came again and, as before, met the Lord.

5 With them came a devotee named Kālidāsa, who knew nothing but the name of Kṛṣṇa.

6 He was a great devotee, simple and generous, and even in his everyday dealings the name of Kṛṣṇa served him as a sign.[2]

7 When he played at dice for fun, he would cast them saying, “Hare Kṛṣṇa! Hare Kṛṣṇa!”[3]

8 He was Raghunātha dāsa’s uncle within the clan, and he had grown old honouring the remnants of Vaiṣṇavas.

9 There was no Vaiṣṇava in Gauḍa whose remnants he had not taken.

10 He would go to every Vaiṣṇava of brāhmaṇa birth, great and small, bringing the finest things as gifts.

11 He would beg them for the plates with their remnants, and where he was refused, he would hide nearby.

12 When a Vaiṣṇava had eaten and thrown his plate away, Kālidāsa would secretly take it up and lick it clean.

13 He went with gifts to the homes of Vaiṣṇavas of śūdra birth as well, and in the same way secretly took their remnants.

14 There was a Vaiṣṇava named Jhaḍu, of the *bhūṅimāli* caste. Kālidāsa went to his home, taking mangoes with him.[4]

15 He presented the mangoes, bowed at his feet, and then paid his respects to his wife.

16 Jhaḍu Ṭhākura was sitting with his wife; seeing Kālidāsa, he received him with great respect.

17 After talking with him a while, Jhaḍu Ṭhākura said to him sweetly:

18 “I am of low birth, and you are a most honoured guest. How shall I serve you?

19 Give me leave to take provisions to a brāhmaṇa's house. There you can take *prasāda*, and that will give me life."

20 Kālidāsa said, "Ṭhākura, be merciful to me! I, a fallen sinner, have come to see you.

21 By seeing you I have become pure. My purpose is fulfilled, and my life has borne its fruit.

22 I have one desire, if you will be merciful: give me the dust of your feet, and place your foot on my head."

23 The Ṭhākura said, "It is not fitting to say such things. I am of low birth, and you are a noble gentleman."

24 Then Kālidāsa recited verses for him, and hearing them, Jhaḍu Ṭhākura was greatly pleased.

25 "Even a knower of the four Vedas is not dear to Me if he is not devoted to Me, but My devotee is dear to Me even if he was born a dog-eater. One should give to him and accept from him; he is to be worshipped just as I am." (Itihāsa-samuccaya, quoted in Hari-bhakti-vilāsa, 10.91)[5]

26 "I consider a dog-eater whose mind, words, deeds, wealth and very life are offered to the Lord of the lotus navel better than a brāhmaṇa endowed with the twelve qualities who has turned away from His lotus feet. Such a devotee purifies his whole family; the brāhmaṇa swollen with pride cannot." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 7.9.10)[6]

27 "Oh, how wonderful! Even a dog-eater is worthy of the highest honour if Your name is on the tip of his tongue. Those who utter Your name have already performed austerities and offered sacrifices; they have bathed in all

the holy waters, they are truly noble, and they have studied the Vedas." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 3.33.7)[7]

28 Hearing this, the Ṭhākura said, "What scripture says is true: one in whom there is devotion to Kṛṣṇa is not low.[89]

29 But I am of low birth, and I have no devotion to Kṛṣṇa. Others may be so blessed, but I have no such power."[10]

30 Bowing to him, Kālidāsa asked leave to go, and Jhaḍu Ṭhākura walked after him to see him off.

31 When the Ṭhākura had seen him off and returned home, Kālidāsa went to the spot where Jhaḍu's footprints lay.

32 He gathered up that dust, smeared it all over his body, and then hid near Jhaḍu's house.

33 Entering the house, Jhaḍu Ṭhākura saw the mangoes and offered them all to Kṛṣṇacandra within his mind.[11]

34 His wife took the mangoes out of their wrappings of banana leaf and bark and handed them to him, and he ate them, sucking out the juice.[12]

35 He sucked the stones and threw them into the wrappings; and when his wife had fed him, she ate after him.[13]

36 She filled the wrappings with the sucked stones, carried them outside and threw them into the pit for remnants.

37 Kālidāsa sucked those wrappings, stones and skins, and as he went on, he grew ever more jubilant with divine love.[14]

38 In this way Kālidāsa honoured the remnants of all the Vaiṣṇavas who lived in the land of Gauḍa.

39 When Kālidāsa came to Nīlācala, Mahāprabhu showed him great mercy.

40 Every day, when the Lord went to see Lord Jagannātha, Govinda accompanied Him with His waterpot.

41 On the north side of the Siṁha-dvāra, sheltered behind the gate, at the foot of the twenty-two steps, there was a small pit.[15]

42 In that pit the Lord would wash His feet, and then He would go to see Lord Jagannātha.

43 Mahāprabhu had given Govinda a rule: “See that no one takes the water that washes My feet.”[16]

44 No living being could take that water; only intimate devotees contrived to get it, on one pretext or another.

45 One day, as the Lord was washing His feet there, Kālidāsa came and held out his cupped hands.

46 He drank one palmful, two palmfuls, three palmfuls, and then Mahāprabhu stopped him:

47 “From now on, do not do this again. With this much I have fulfilled your desire.”

48 Lord Caitanya, crest jewel of the all-knowing, knew Kālidāsa’s heart and his faith in the Vaiṣṇavas.

49 Pleased with him for that quality, the Lord showed him a mercy rarely granted to others.[17]

50 Beyond the twenty-two steps, at the top on the south side, on the left as one goes up, stands a Deity of Lord Nṛsiṁha.

51 Every day the Lord would bow down to Him and recite this verse again and again:

52 “Obeisance to You, Lord Narasiṁha, who give joy to Prahlāda, and whose nails are a chisel on the stone of Hiraṇyakaśipu’s chest.” (Nṛsiṁha-purāṇa)[18]

53 “Nṛsiṁha is here, Nṛsiṁha is there; wherever I go, there is Nṛsiṁha. Nṛsiṁha is outside, Nṛsiṁha is in the heart. I take shelter of Nṛsiṁha, the original Lord.” (Nṛsiṁha-purāṇa)[19]

54 Then the Lord had *darśana* of Jagannātha, and on returning home He took His midday meal.

55 Kālidāsa was waiting hopefully at the outer door. Knowing this, the Lord gave Govinda a sign.

56 Govinda understood all the Lord’s signs and gave Kālidāsa the plate with the Lord’s remnants.

57 Such is the greatness of the remnants of Vaiṣṇavas: by taking them Kālidāsa received the Lord’s mercy in its fullest measure.

58 Therefore, casting off disgust and shame, take the remnants (*jhuṭā*) of Vaiṣṇavas; through them you will obtain all you desire.

59 The remnants of Kṛṣṇa are called *mahā-prasāda*; when they become the remnants of a devotee, they are called *mahā-mahā-prasāda*.

60 The dust of a devotee's feet, the water that has washed his feet, and the remnants of what he has eaten — these three are the strength of spiritual practice.[20]

61 By serving these three one attains love for Kṛṣṇa; all the scriptures declare this loudly again and again.

62 Therefore I tell you over and over: listen, O devotees! Serve these three with faith.

63 These three bring the joy of Kṛṣṇa's name and of love for Him, and through them one gains Kṛṣṇa's grace. Kālidāsa is the witness to this.

64 In this way Mahāprabhu lived in Nīlācala, and without anyone noticing He showed Kālidāsa great mercy.

65 That year Śivānanda came with his wife and brought with him his youngest son, Purī dāsa.[21]

66 Taking his son, he came to the Lord and had the boy bow at His feet.

67 Again and again the Lord said, "Say 'Kṛṣṇa'!" But the boy stayed silent and would not utter the name of Kṛṣṇa.

68 Śivānanda did all he could to persuade the boy, but still the boy did not say the name of Kṛṣṇa.

69 The Lord said, "I have made the whole world chant the holy name; I have made even trees and stones say the name of Kṛṣṇa.

70 Yet I could not make this boy say the name of Kṛṣṇa!" Hearing this, Svarūpa Gosāñi said:

71 "You have instructed him in the mantra of Kṛṣṇa's name. Having received the mantra, he will not disclose it to anyone.[22]

72 He chants it silently, within, but does not speak it aloud. That, I think, is his intention."

73 Another day the Lord said, "Recite, Purī dāsa!" and the boy composed and recited this verse:

74 "Glory to Hari! He is all the adornment of the girls of Vṛndāvana: the blue lotus at their ears, the collyrium of their eyes, the necklace of great sapphires upon their breast." (Āryā-śataka, 1)[23]

75 He was a child of seven, who had not studied, yet he composed such a verse! Everyone was amazed.

76 Such is the greatness of Caitanya Prabhu's mercy; even Brahmā and the other gods cannot find its limit.

77 The devotees stayed with the Lord for four months; then He gave them leave, and they all went back to Gauḍa.

78 In their company the Lord kept His external awareness, but when they had gone, His divine madness again prevailed.[24]

79 Night and day Kṛṣṇa's form, fragrance and taste appeared to Him; He experienced them directly, as if Kṛṣṇa were touching Him.[25]

80 One day, when the Lord went to see Jagannātha, the doorkeeper came up to Him at the Siṁha-dvāra and bowed down.[26]

81 The Lord said to him, “Where is Kṛṣṇa, the Lord of My life? Show Me Kṛṣṇa!” and took him by the hand.

82 The doorkeeper said, “The son of the king of Vraja is here. Come with me and I will show Him to You.”

83 “You are My friend. Show Me where the Lord of My life is!” Saying this, the Lord went into the *jagamohana*, holding the man’s hand.

84 The doorkeeper said, “Here is Śrī Puruṣottama. Fill Your eyes with the sight of Him.”

85 Standing behind the Garuḍa pillar, the Lord gazed, and He saw that Jagannātha was Kṛṣṇa with the flute at His lips.

86 Raghunātha dāsa has described this pastime in his own book, the *Caitanya-stava-kalpavṛkṣa*:

87 “‘Friend, where is My beloved Kṛṣṇa? Show Him to Me here, quickly — only you can!’ So, as if mad, Gaurāṅga spoke to the doorkeeper; and when the man said, ‘Come quickly and see Your Beloved,’ He took hold of his hand. That Gaurāṅga, rising in my heart, makes me mad with joy.” (Caitanya-stava-kalpavṛkṣa, 7)[27]

88 At that time the *gopāla-vallabha* offering was placed before Jagannātha, and the *ārati* began to the sound of conchshells, bells and other instruments.[28]

89 When the offering was over, Jagannātha's servants came to the Lord with *prasāda*.

90 Placing a garland on Him, they put the *prasāda* into the Lord's hands. Let alone its taste — its very fragrance intoxicated the mind.

91 That *prasāda* was very precious, the finest of all things, and the servant did his best to have the Lord taste a little of it.

92 The Lord took a little of it and put it on His tongue; all the rest He tied in the end of Govinda's cloth.

93 Tasting what was sweeter than millions of nectars, the Lord was struck with wonder. His hair stood on end all over His body, and streams of tears flowed from His eyes.

94 "How has this food come by such a taste? The nectar of Kṛṣṇa's lips has entered it!"

95 At this thought Mahāprabhu was overcome by love, but seeing Jagannātha's servant, He restrained Himself.[29]

96 Again and again He said, "A particle of the remnants, gained by *sukṛti*!" Jagannātha's servant asked, "What does this mean?"[30]

97 The Lord said, "What you have given Me is the nectar of Kṛṣṇa's lips. Even Brahmā and the gods can hardly obtain it, and it puts nectar itself to shame.

98 The remnants of what Kṛṣṇa has eaten are called *phelā*. Whoever obtains even a particle of it is fortunate.

99 It cannot be attained by ordinary good fortune. Only one on whom Kṛṣṇa's full mercy rests obtains it.[31]

100 The word *sukṛti* means the piety that is the cause of Kṛṣṇa's mercy. Whoever has it obtains *phelā* and is blessed."[32]

101 Having said this, the Lord gave the servants leave to go, and after seeing the *upala-bhoga* offering He returned to His residence.

102 He performed His midday duties and finished His meal, but all the while He remembered the nectar of Kṛṣṇa's lips within His heart.

103 He carried out His outward duties, but His mind was overflowing with love; His absorption was intense, and He restrained it only with great difficulty.

104 After His evening duties He again sat in seclusion with His own associates, delighting in many talks about Kṛṣṇa.

105 At the Lord's sign Govinda brought the *prasāda*, and the Lord sent some to Paramānanda Purī and Brahmānanda Bhāratī.

106 He divided the *prasāda* and gave it to all — Rāmānanda, Sārvabhauma, Svarūpa and the others.

107 When they savoured the fragrance and sweetness of the *prasāda*, all were amazed at its unearthly taste.

108–109 The Lord said, "All these are material substances — sugar, camphor, black pepper, cardamom, cloves, ghee, spices, cinnamon and the rest. Everyone knows the taste of material things.[33]

110 Yet these substances have a taste and a fragrance beyond this world. Taste them and see for yourselves.

111 Let alone its taste — its fragrance alone intoxicates the mind and makes one forget every sweetness but its own.

112 Therefore Kṛṣṇa's lips must have touched this food, and all the qualities of His lips have passed into it.

113 An unearthly fragrance and taste, and the power to make one forget everything else — such are the greatly intoxicating qualities of Kṛṣṇa's lips.[34]

114 We have gained this through much *sukṛti*. Now all of you, taste it with great devotion."

115 Calling out the name of Hari, they all tasted it, and as they did so their minds grew mad with love.

116 When Mahāprabhu, absorbed in love, gave the order, Rāmānanda Rāya began to recite verses.

117 "O hero, grant us the nectar of Your lips. It deepens the longing for union and destroys grief; Your sounding flute kisses it tenderly, and it makes men forget every other attachment." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 10.31.14)[35]

118 Mahāprabhu was greatly pleased to hear it, and He began to recite a verse of Rādhā's eager longing:

119 "O friend, the shining nectar of His lips takes from the incomparable noble ladies of Vraja all thirst for any other taste; a particle of His remnants is gained only by *sukṛti*; and He chews rolls of fine betel leaves sweeter

than nectar. That Madana-mohana of Mine deepens the craving of My tongue." (Govinda-līlāmṛta, 8.8)[36]

120 Having said this, Gaura Prabhu, absorbed in feeling, explained the meaning of the two verses in raving words (*pralāpa*).

121–122 "O Beloved, hear the ways of Your lips! They stir the body and mind, increase the longing for union, and take away the burden of joy, grief and all the rest. They make one forget every other taste, bring the whole world under their sway, and destroy shame, duty and composure. They intoxicate the minds of women and draw them on, kindling the craving of the tongue. Yet when I think it over, everything about them is contrary.[37]

123 Let alone women — I am ashamed even to say it: Your lips are the boldest of masters. They draw even a man to them, longing to give themselves to him to drink, and make him forget every other taste.[38]

124 Let alone the conscious — Your lips make even the unconscious conscious; they are a great magician! Your flute is nothing but dry firewood, yet they give it senses and a mind and let it drink of them ceaselessly.[39]

125 The flute, a brazen man, drinks and drinks the lips of a man and tells the gopīs of its drinking: 'Listen, O gopīs! I am drinking your wealth by force. If you have any pride,

126 then be angry with me, cast off shame, fear and duty, and I will yield it to you: come and drink. Otherwise I shall drink it without end. I have no fear of you, and all others I count as straw.'

127 The flute mixes the nectar of Your lips with its own sound, and by that power it draws the people of the three worlds. And if we, fearing for our duty, try to keep our composure, it makes a mockery of us.

128 Before our elders it loosens the knots at our waists and makes us abandon shame and duty. As if seizing us by the hair, it leads us away, brings us to You and makes us Your maidservants, and people laugh to hear of it. This is how it makes women dance!

129 A stick of dry bamboo heaps such insults on us! Like a master, it has brought us to this state. What can we do but bear it? So we keep silent: when a thief is punished, his mother cannot call out and weep.[40]

130 Such is the way of Your lips. Now hear the bad custom of whatever meets those lips: any food or drink they touch becomes like nectar and is called 'Kṛṣṇa's *phelā*'.[41]

131 Not one of the gods can obtain a particle of that *phelā* — who would believe such a boast? Only piety gathered over many births bears the name *sukṛti*, and by that *sukṛti* one obtains a particle of it.

132 The betel Kṛṣṇa chews is said to be beyond price, and on top of that comes this artful boast: what He has chewed they call 'the essence of nectar', and they make the gopīs' mouths its cup, its *ālabāṭī*.[42]

133 All this is Your trickery. Give up this artfulness! Why do You steal our lives with Your flute? Do not, for Your own amusement, make Yourself guilty of killing women. Give us the gift of the nectar of Your lips."[43]

134 As He spoke, the Lord's mood changed: His angry mind grew calm, and His longing increased.

135 "This nectar of Kṛṣṇa's lips is supremely rare. Whoever obtains it has found the fruit of life.

136 If one who is worthy cannot drink it and still clings to life, he is shameless and lives in vain.

137 The unworthy drink it constantly, while the worthy do not get it and only die of longing.

138 So I know there is power in some austerity: as its fruit, the unworthy are given the nectar of Kṛṣṇa's lips.

139 Tell Me something, Rāmarāya — My mind longs to hear." Knowing His mood, Rāmānanda recited the words of the gopīs:

140 "O gopīs, what good deed did this flute perform, that it enjoys of its own accord the nectar of Dāmodara's lips, which belongs to the gopīs, leaving only a taste of it behind? The rivers that nourished it thrill with joy, their lotuses like hair standing on end, and the trees shed tears, like elders of a family rejoicing in a descendant." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 10.21.9)[44]

141 Hearing this verse, the Lord became absorbed in feeling, and in His longing He explained its meaning in raving words.

142 "Ah, the son of the king of Vraja will certainly marry some maidens of Vraja. Because of that bond the gopīs know this nectar as their own wealth, and it is not for others to attain.[45]

143 O gopīs, think it over together and tell Me: what holy place, what austerity, what chanting of a perfect mantra did this flute perform in a former birth?[46]

144 Such is the nectar of Kṛṣṇa's lips: it has eclipsed nectar itself, and only in the hope of it do the gopīs keep their lives. Yet this flute, utterly unwor-

thy, an unmoving thing, and of the male sex besides, drinks that nectar all the time.[47]

145 Without asking those to whom this wealth belongs, it drinks it by force and loudly calls them to come and drink. See the fruit of its austerity, the power of its good fortune: even the great partake of its remnants.[48]

146 The Mānasa-gaṅgā and the Kālindī are rivers that purify the world. When Kṛṣṇa bathes in them, they are overpowered by longing and joyfully drink the taste of His lips left over by the flute.

147 But let alone the rivers! The trees on their banks perform austerities and do good to others; yet they take the taste the rivers have left, draw it up through their roots and drink it — why, I cannot understand.[4950]

148 Their new shoots are their hair standing on end, their flowers are blossoming laughter, and in the guise of honey streams of tears flow from them. They regard the flute as their own kin and are overcome with bliss, as a noble man is when his sons and grandsons become Vaiṣṇavas.

149 When we know what austerity the flute performed, we will perform the same. It is unworthy, and we are worthy women. We are dying of grief for want of what the unworthy one drinks, and we cannot bear it. That is why we are pondering its austerity."

150 Thus Gaurahari lamented, absorbed in love. With Svarūpa and Rāmarāya at His side He sometimes danced, sometimes sang, and sometimes, overcome by feeling, fell into a swoon. In this way His nights and days passed.[51]

151 Placing on my head the holy feet of Svarūpa, Rūpa, Sanātana and Raghunātha, and hoping for their mercy, I, Kṛṣṇadāsa, lowly and fallen,

sing the *Caitanya-caritāmṛta*, a nectar surpassing nectar.

Notes

1. *Anubhāṣya*: the nectar of feelings for Kṛṣṇa is the exalted, radiant *ujjvala-rasa*; initiation into prema (*prema-dīkṣā*) is the path of service rooted in pure love. Heading in the edition: obeisance to Gaura, who teaches bhakti by His own example. ↩
2. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: in his worldly dealings he used the name of Kṛṣṇa as a conventional sign (*saṅketa*). ↩
3. *Anubhāṣya*: if a soul full of *anarthas* does not follow Kālidāsa's firm devotion to the holy name, but for the pleasure of the senses imitates this outward play of his and grows addicted to dice, its bondage to Kali will only increase its bent for sin (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 1.17.38–41). And its outward imitation of chanting, which prompts it to sin in reliance on the power of the name, will end only in offence to the name (*nāmāparādha*). ↩
4. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: the bhūṅimālis are a caste like the haḍḍis. *Anubhāṣya*: the homes of Kālidāsa and Jhaḍu Ṭhākura were in the village of Bhedo (Bhaduyā), about three miles south of Kṛṣṇapura, the birthplace of Śrīla Raghunātha dāsa Gosvāmī. ↩
5. The same verse as Madhya 19.50 and 20.58; translation as there. Heading in the edition here: "Words of the Lord in the *Itihāsa-samuccaya*" (at Madhya 19.50: *Hari-bhakti-vilāsa* 10.91, words of the *Itihāsa-samuccaya*). The *Anubhāṣya* refers to Madhya 19.50. ↩
6. The same verse as Antya 4.69 and Madhya 20.59; translation as there. The *Anubhāṣya* refers to Madhya 20.59. ↩
7. The same verse as Madhya 11.192 and 19.72; translation as there. The *Anubhāṣya* refers to Madhya 11.192. ↩
8. So in the Gauḍīya Maṭha edition: *śāstra ei satya haya / sei nīca nahe, — yāṅte kṛṣṇa-bhakti kaya*. Other editions read *śāstra ei satya kaya / sei śreṣṭha, aiche yāṅte kṛṣṇa-bhakti haya*, "the scriptures speak this truth: the best is one in whom there is devotion to Kṛṣṇa." ↩
9. *Anubhāṣya*: the *Mahābhārata*, the *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam*, the *Padma-purāṇa* and many other scriptures make it clear that transcendental brahminhood belongs eternally to a Vaiṣṇava. Therefore one who has gained devotion to Kṛṣṇa, even if born in a low family, can no longer be of low caste. ↩

10. *Anubhāṣya*: the words “I have no devotion” show only Jhaḍu Ṭhākura’s magnanimity, worthy of a Vaiṣṇava, and his freedom from pride. Great devotees do not identify with the body, and by nature they speak with the humility of pure devotees: “All the devotees of Kṛṣṇa stand high; I alone have no devotion and am born in a low family.” ↩
11. Heading in the edition: Jhaḍu Ṭhākura, the guru of all brāhmaṇas, worships within his mind the Deity revealed in the mind, and then eats the mangoes as Kṛṣṇa’s remnants. ↩
12. *Anubhāṣya*: *pāṭuyā-kholā* — leaves and bark; *nikāśiyā* — taking out. ↩
13. Heading in the edition: the wife of a Vaiṣṇava honours the remnants of her Vaiṣṇava husband’s meal. ↩
14. Heading in the edition: the most fortunate Kālidāsa, in great bliss, honours the remnants of a Vaiṣṇava’s meal, seeing them as transcendental. ↩
15. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: the Oriyās call each step of a stair a *pahāca*; to go up through the Siṁha-dvāra one must climb twenty-two such steps. *Anubhāṣya*: *āḍe* — in a secluded spot, behind a screen; these places are no longer empty, for houses have been built there. ↩
16. Heading in the edition: the strict rule of the Lord, who as an ācārya teaches the world. ↩
17. Heading in the edition: for his transcendental faith in the Vaiṣṇavas the Lord shows Kālidāsa a mercy rare even for Brahmā and the other gods. ↩
18. Heading in the edition: obeisance to Śrī Nṛsiṁha, the sole protector of the devotees who preach pure bhakti, the crusher of the godless, to whom the devotees are dear (two verses of the *Nṛsiṁha-purāṇa*). ↩
19. *Anubhāṣya*: “here” — in this world (Devī-dhāma); “there” — in the spiritual sky (Paravyoma); “outside” — in the manifest world; “in the heart” — in the inner world. Heading in the edition: the preacher of pure bhakti sees Śrī Nṛsiṁhadeva everywhere as his protector. ↩
20. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: to take the dust of a devotee’s feet, the water that has washed his feet, and the nectar of his lips (*adharāmṛta*) — in these three lies the strength of every spiritual practice. ↩
21. Heading in the edition: for the Ratha-yātrā Śivānanda comes to Purī with his son Paramānanda Purī dāsa. This is the future poet Kavi-karṇapūra: the edition gives verse 74 as the first verse of his *Āryā-śataka*. ↩
22. *Anubhāṣya*: if a mantra received from Śrī Gurudeva is disclosed to another, it loses its potency; we know this already from the story of Śrī Gadādhara Paṇḍita. ↩

23. *Anubhāṣya*: *akhilaṁ maṇḍanam* — “every adornment”: Hari Himself is the whole adornment of the girls of Vraja; *mahendra-maṇi* — sapphire (*indranīla*). Heading in the edition: glory to Kṛṣṇa, the ornament of the gopīs’ hearts; the first verse of Kavi-karṇapūra’s *Āryā-śataka*. ↩
24. Heading in the edition: in the company of the devotees of Gauḍa, in His outward state, the Lord preached through talks about Kṛṣṇa and kīrtana; left without them, in His inner state He became mad in the mood of a gopī separated from Kṛṣṇa. ↩
25. Heading in the edition: in separation the Lord constantly feels Kṛṣṇa’s nearness — Kṛṣṇa appears to Him (*sphūrti*). ↩
26. Heading in the edition: the Lord’s words in *udghūrṇā* (bewilderment of feeling); in the form of Jagannātha He sees Śyāmasundara. ↩
27. *Anubhāṣya*: *madayati* — “fills with bliss”; so too the refrain of this prayer in Antya 6.327. Heading in the edition: *Stava-mālā*, *Caitanya-stava-kalpavṛkṣa*, verse 7. ↩
28. Heading in the edition: the morning offering (*bālya-bhoga*) to Jagannātha. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: in these parts the *vallabha-bhoga* is called *bāla-bhoga*. ↩
29. Heading in the edition: recognising the nectar of Kṛṣṇa’s lips, the Lord is overcome by prema, but on seeing a servant whose service rests on majesty (*aiśvarya*) He conceals it. ↩
30. *Anubhāṣya*: the *Mahābhārata* and the *Skanda-purāṇa* (Utkala-khaṇḍa) say: “O king, those of little piety never come to have faith in *mahā-prasāda*, in Govinda, in the Name who is Brahman, and in the Vaiṣṇava.” ↩
31. *Anubhāṣya*: “ordinary fortune” is good fortune born of the fruits of karma. Heading in the edition: here the fruits of *sukṛti* directed to karma and of *sukṛti* directed to bhakti are distinguished. ↩
32. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: *sukṛti* is the pious act that gives rise to Kṛṣṇa’s mercy (*sukṛti* directed to bhakti). ↩
33. *Anubhāṣya*: *rasavāsa* — fragrant cardamom and cloves; *guḍatvaka* — cinnamon or mace; “material” (*prākṛta*) — whatever the conditioned soul enjoys for the sake of its own happiness: fragmentary, limited and perishable. Heading in the edition: the Lord shows how the material things enjoyed by the conditioned soul differ from *naivedya*, the spiritual offerings enjoyed by Kṛṣṇa’s spiritual senses. ↩
34. Heading in the edition: the spiritual offerings touched by Kṛṣṇa’s lips intoxicate the devotee’s spiritual senses. ↩

35. *Anubhāṣya*: the gopīs pray for this in separation, when Kṛṣṇa has vanished during the rāsa dance; “hero” — hero of generosity (*dāna-vīra*); “longing for union” — the desire for *sambhoga*; “other attachments” — attachment to any happiness unconnected with Kṛṣṇa. Heading in the edition: the gopīs pray for the nectar of Kṛṣṇa’s lips (*citra-jalpa*). ↩
36. *Anubhāṣya*: “the craving of the tongue” — the craving of a tongue eager to serve Kṛṣṇa. Heading in the edition: Śrī Rādhā’s words to Viśākhā. ↩
37. Heading in the edition: explanation of the first verse; the spiritual power of the nectar of Kṛṣṇa’s lips; tune — any (*yathā-rāga*). The line “O Beloved, hear…” is marked in the edition as a refrain (*dhruva*). *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: Kṛṣṇa’s lips intoxicate the minds of women and draw them, kindling the craving of the tongue. ↩
38. *Anubhāṣya*: *dhṛṣṭa-rāya* — brazen, the first among the insolent. ↩
39. Heading in the edition: Śrī Rādhā’s jealousy of Kṛṣṇa’s flute. ↩
40. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: the flute is only a stick of dry bamboo, yet like a master it humiliates the gopīs; a thief’s mother cannot call people and weep to have him saved — so the gopīs keep silent. ↩
41. Heading in the edition: explanation of the second verse; the glory of the nectar of Kṛṣṇa’s lips. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: the “bad custom” belongs to whatever meets the lips: food and drink they have touched become nectar, and the *phelā* is so proud that ordinary people cannot believe it. ↩
42. *Anubhāṣya*: *ālabāṭī* — a *bāṭī* (bowl) for *āla* (saliva), a spittoon. ↩
43. The *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya* gives two readings: “if You become a killer of women, You Yourself will be blamed — so do not do it”, and “do not kill women for Your own amusement”. ↩
44. *Anubhāṣya*: the gopīs say this in autumn, when Kṛṣṇa is herding the cows in the forest and playing His flute. The rivers nourished the flute with their water and are like mothers to it; the trees are its kin: as the elders of a family tremble and weep on seeing a servant of the Lord born in their line, so the trees shed tears of bliss — streams of honey. ↩
45. Heading in the edition: seeing the good fortune of the flute that drinks the nectar of Kṛṣṇa’s lips, the gopīs speak of it jealously — and yet praise it (*citra-jalpa*). ↩
46. The line “O gopīs, think it over…” is marked in the edition as a refrain (*dhruva*). ↩
47. *Anubhāṣya*: *ye kaila amṛta-mudā* — according to some, the nectar of Kṛṣṇa’s lips by the power of its sweetness covers (conquers) even nectar. ↩

48. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: “the great” (*mahājana*) are the Mānasa-gaṅgā and the Yamunā: they are holy rivers. ↩
49. So in the Gauḍīya Maṭha edition: *e-ta nadī rahu dūre*, “let alone the rivers”. Other editions read *e-ta nārī bahu dūre*, “let alone women”. ↩
50. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: holy though they are, they are still rivers; so they can drink the taste of Kṛṣṇa’s lips left over by the flute. ↩
51. Heading in the edition: the Lord’s madness of love for Kṛṣṇa in the mood of the gopīs. ↩